

**Workshop**

Here's how to tell a conversational story unlike any other through what else but Tapestry

**Tips & tricks**

This month's bag of tricks focuses on OS X Mavericks, the ever popular Instagram and Teamviewer

# Dysfunctional USB ports, weird hard drive and erratic monitors

Computers have been acting weird ever since they were invented and we've been solving such problems ever since we came into the picture

## Need a Full-HD display

Hello Sir,

My problem is that I want to buy a 21 to 23-inch Full HD monitor. I want an IPS panel solution and despite seeing Digit's top five monitors page but I'm still confused. I do office work so it has to have good readability and I also play games occasionally. My budget is up to ₹10,000. Please do reply via email as I am now using a borrowed monitor.

—Dilip Pandey

 Hey Dilip,

We tested out quite a few monitors back in May 2014 and the BenQ GW2255HM won the Best Buy award in the sub-₹10,000 category. However, with a rated response time (G-t-G) of six seconds you can expect a little bit of ghosting in fast paced games but the magnitude of ghosting that one is comfortable with varies from person to person. If you do find it to be unappealing then you may want to consider the GL2250HM, also from BenQ. This one has a rated response time of two seconds which makes it ideal for gaming. However, its contrast ratio is 390:1 compared to the GW2255HM's 1081:1 so the difference between the level of detail is considerable but it won't affect day to day office work. If you are fine with the six second response time then go for the BenQ GW2255HM, otherwise go for the GL2250HM.

## Laptop isn't starting

Hi Digit,

Well my laptop isn't starting. It's around four years old.

Configuration:

- Dell Inspiron 15R N5010
- Intel Core i5 @ 2.53 GHz
- 4 GB RAM @ 1333 MHz
- 500 GB HDD @ 5400 RPM

- 1 GB ATI RADEON HD 550v Graphics
- The laptop isn't starting at all. As soon as I switch it on, only the power button glows, nothing else happens. Can't even hear the fans running. When the same problem occurred earlier, the laptop's screen used to shake up, flicker and act weird. Once it



Clean your laptop before it conks off due to heat

even threw up a BSOD. After that it hasn't started. A year ago, I replaced my HDD with a new WD Blue. Even the screen was replaced 3 years ago by Dell. I want to know whether is it an HDD problem, screen problem, or something else? Please help me out with a solution at the soonest because my work has come to a halt due to my non-functional laptop.

—Sagar Bakre

 Hey Sagar,

There could be a plethora of reasons as to why your laptop conked off and isn't starting. If you recall what error message was displayed on the Blue Screen of Death then you can Google the same and throw more light on the situation. If the HDD had crashed the computer should have completed POST. Have you tried a different battery or a compatible charger? It seems to us that this is most likely a heating problem. Often the cooling fan gets clogged with dirt and the cooling

efficiency drops. Over time the excess heat starts affecting all the components near the affected area. If your graphics chipset used the same heatsink as the CPU then that gets affected as well. If left unchecked it leads to permanent damage to these individual components. And since these are onboard components the only solution would be to get those individual components replaced. An authorised service centre will replace the entire motherboard at a huge cost and if your laptop is still covered by Dell's warranty then call them up at the earliest. Or you can go to a local repair shop and they'll replace the affected component but they give little or no warranty for the replaced component.

## Dysfunctional ports on a laptop; recovery solution

Hi there, I have a HP ProBook 445 and I am facing some issues.

1. The laptop has four USB ports equally distributed on both sides. Ports on the left side have stopped working.
2. My laptop had Ubuntu out of the box then I installed Windows 7. While installing I deleted the recovery partition. Is there any way to get it back? Thanks in advance.

—Vipul Yadav



The daughterboard (bottom-left) has USB and audio, clean the connector and re-attach